



Personal & Confidential

President Barack Obama

Alliance for Collective Empowerment and Development

v3.1 - June 2026

Léandre Poplus, Founder

For Our People, By Our People.

ACE

DEAR PRESIDENT TO BAMA

My name is Léandre Poplus. I am the founder of the Alliance for Collective Empowerment and Development. You spent eight years inside an institution that by design was built to keep men and women who look like you out. I come to you respectfully, in the hope of leveraging that insider knowledge as guidance to what we are building.

You are the only former President who has stood at the exact intersection where this initiative lives: the tension between operating inside American systems and carrying the full weight of what those systems have done and continue to do to people of color in this country. You have navigated that tension at the highest level any person can. ACE needs that navigation now.

The Alliance for Collective Empowerment is a 25-year initiative to build a network of self-governing, self-sustaining cities for Black and Native American communities on tribal land protected by sovereign law, funded by community capital, governed by a constitutional framework written by the community it serves.

This is not a movement without a map. The enclosed ACE Act is 22 Titles and over 1,600 paragraphs: a founding constitution, a phased 25-year development plan, a tribal engagement strategy, a healthcare system, an education system from kindergarten through medical school, a community finance model, a formal tax equity initiative, and a 33.15 million acre contingency land claim grounded in a per-person calculation of what was promised and broken in 1865.

We are not asking for your public endorsement. We understand the complexity of your position. We are asking for something more valuable: your private assessment of whether this framework is sound, and if you believe it is your willingness to say so to the people whose support will determine whether it is built.

WHY ACE HAD TO BE BUILT

Black institutions are not strangers to having reached the height of their power. Tulsa, Greenwood, The Freedmen's Bureau. Yet these are the very institutions COINTELPRO was designed to destroy. Every time, the system responded to Black success not with recognition but with removal. You understand that pattern better than most, because you governed inside it. ACE was built with that history in mind.

Every legal protection in the ACE Act exists because we studied what happened to what came before us and chose to build accordingly. The question we are bringing to you is not whether this vision is necessary. We believe you already know that it is. The question is whether the architecture is sound enough to survive what will come for it.

That is why we need your counsel, not your endorsement.

THE ASK

Will you help us navigate this correctly?

If you review the enclosed proposal and believe it is serious, legally grounded, and worthy of the attention of the people who have the resources and the influence to make it real a private word from you to any of them changes everything.

If you have concerns about the framework, we want to hear them before we move further. Your knowledge of what can be legally and politically defended, and what cannot, is irreplaceable.

We will follow up through the Obama Foundation within 90 days of this delivery. If you choose not to respond, we will proceed and we will not make your silence public. ACE builds what ACE builds. But we believe you should see this first.

We are not asking you to carry this. We are asking you to tell us if we are carrying it correctly.

We also recognize that decisions of this weight are rarely made alone. If Michelle reads this with you, we hope she reads it closely. She has spent her career thinking about what institutions owe the communities they were built to serve, and her perspective on what ACE is building is one we would not take lightly.

The full ACE Act is enclosed. We would welcome your time.

SUPPORTING LEGAL DOCUMENTATION, AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST

The following documents have been prepared and are available to you upon request:

- **ACE Sovereign Territory Act: Companion Legal Brief v1.3** - Pre-argument legal defense of ACE's contingency land claim across ten states of existing federal public land, grounded in the Continuity Doctrine and the Federally Recognized Indian Tribe List Act of 1994.
- **ACE Submission to the United Nations CERD v1.1** - Formal civil society submission to the Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination's active General Recommendation on reparations for chattel enslavement, filed June 2026.

DIRECT CONTACT

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Private Investment Proposal

Wealth at Scale

Alliance for Collective Empowerment and Development

v1.9 - June 2026

Léandre Poplus, Founder

For Our People, By Our People.

ALLIANCE FOR COLLECTIVE EMPOWERMENT

ACE

WHY ACE EXISTS

You did not accumulate what you have by accident. You built it inside a system that was not designed for you, often in spite of that system, and you carry the knowledge of exactly how much was left on the table because the infrastructure to capture it did not exist.

ACE is that infrastructure. Not for your generation alone. For the one that comes after, and the one after that. The question your wealth is asking, whether you have answered it yet or not, is what it will have built in 100 years. ACE is the answer to that question.

WE ARE BUILDING A CITY

Not a community program. Not a nonprofit initiative. A city. Built on tribal sovereign land, protected by federal law, funded by our own people, governed by our own hands.

The Alliance for Collective Empowerment (ACE) is a 25-year initiative to establish a network of self-governing, self-sustaining cities for Black and Native American communities across the United States. The legal foundation is tribal sovereignty land that sits outside state taxation, outside municipal zoning, and outside many of the regulations that have historically been used to strangle Black economic development before it could take root.

The first city. Then ten. Built to house, educate, and provide healthcare for 32 million Black Americans on their own terms, in their own institutions, under their own government. This is not the American dream. It is something we design ourselves.

The math is real. 32 million people. 24 million acres needed. A long-range network of ACE cities each supported by a tribal sovereign partnership with land holdings running into the millions of acres. Schools built on that land. Hospitals. A university system. A renewable energy grid that powers the community and sells surplus to the region. A cooperative economy that keeps every dollar circulating within the community three times before it leaves.

Your wealth has a question attached to it: What do you want it to have built in 100 years? A house. A portfolio. Or a city? A school that your great-grandchildren's great-grandchildren attend. A hospital where no Black mother fears the delivery room. A university that bears your name because you put it there when no one else would.

THE ASK

We are not asking for charity. We are offering you the most consequential investment opportunity of your lifetime: co-ownership of a civilization.

- Investments above \$1,000,000 are structured as named infrastructure commitments a school, a hospital wing, an energy grid, a university college. Your name on what your capital builds, permanently.

- Investors at this level receive a seat on the ACE Founders Council with direct access to leadership and annual impact reporting.
- Investments at every level are structured as Community Investment Bonds with defined returns, this is not a donation; it is an investment with a return and a legacy.

We would like 30 minutes of your time. The full proposal is enclosed.

The full ACE Act is enclosed. Thank you for your time.



For the Builders of Black Independence

Minister Louis Farrakhan

Alliance for Collective Empowerment and Development

v3.1 - June 2026

Léandre Poplus, Founder

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AS-SALAMU ALAYKUM, MINISTER FARRAKHAN

My name is Léandre Poplus. I am the founder of the Alliance for Collective Empowerment and Development. For more than twenty years, the clarity of your ministry's position on Black sovereignty, self-determination, and the impossibility of true freedom inside a system built to deny it has shaped how I think about what Black people in America actually need. What I am bringing to you today is not a new idea. It is the architecture that the idea has always deserved.

For generations you have taught that Black people in America must build their own economy, own their own land, govern their own communities, and stop begging a system built on our oppression to treat us fairly. You have been right. I share this vision, Minister Farrakhan, and I believe the time to build it has come. ACE introduces a legal and structural foundation, the architecture that turns decades of righteous teaching into a city our people can build, grow and live in.

The Alliance for Collective Empowerment (ACE) is that blueprint.

ACE is a 25-year initiative to establish a network of self-governing, self-sustaining cities for Black and Native American communities on tribal sovereign land land that sits outside state jurisdiction, outside federal taxation of tribal enterprise, and outside many of the legal mechanisms that have historically been used to destroy Black economic and political institutions the moment they became powerful enough to threaten the status quo.

The tribal sovereignty partnership is not symbolic. It is a legal architecture that has survived 200 years of federal attempts to dismantle it. It is the most durable legal protection available to a Black community organization in the United States. And it is available to ACE because Black and Native Americans are natural allies; two peoples dispossessed by the same government, with complementary assets: land and sovereignty on one side, capital and population on the other.

What ACE is building: Cities with their own schools, their own hospitals, their own courts, their own police a peacekeeping corps accountable to the community, not to the state. Their own banks. Their own farms. Their own media. Their own constitution. Their own government. Everything your theology has called for. Architected. Legal. Buildable.

WHY ACE HAD TO BE BUILT

For decades you have said that Black people in America cannot petition their way to freedom, cannot integrate their way to sovereignty, and cannot build lasting power inside institutions designed to contain them. The evidence has agreed with you every time.

What has been missing is not the vision. It is the blueprint. ACE provides the legal architecture and the territorial foundation, secured either through partnership with aligned tribal nations or through the same federal sovereignty protections already extended to recognized tribes. It provides the governing

constitution and the economic model.

Everything you have been calling for, now architected and ready to build. We are not asking you to become ACE. We are showing you that what you have preached is now buildable, and we believe you should be part of building it.

THE ASK

We are not asking you to become ACE. We are showing you that what you have been calling for is now blueprinted and ready to build. We believe you should be part of it.

We are asking for your endorsement of this initiative to your community, the people who trust your voice and have been ready for this moment longer than anyone.

We are asking for your organization's participation as an ACE Community Ministry Partner connecting your network to ACE town halls, investment opportunities, and community development resources.

We are asking for your introduction to others within your sphere of influence who share this vision and have the resources to invest in it.

The door is open. The proposal is enclosed. Let's meet.

The vision you have preached for generations is now architected.

We built it.

The full ACE Act is enclosed. Thank you for your time.

SUPPORTING LEGAL DOCUMENTATION, AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST

The following documents have been prepared and are available to you upon request:

- **ACE Sovereign Territory Act: Companion Legal Brief v1.3** - Pre-argument legal defense of ACE's contingency land claim: 33.15 million acres of existing federal public land across ten states, grounded in a precise calculation: 47 million Black Americans at 0.705 acres per person, less than two percent of the 40-acre promise made and broken in the same year.
- **ACE Submission to the United Nations CERD v1.1** - Formal submission to the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination's active General Recommendation on reparations for chattel enslavement, filed June 2026. The international accountability track the NOI has called for.

DIRECT CONTACT

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Community Leader Engagement

A Message to Community Ministry Leaders

Alliance for Collective Empowerment and Development

v1.9 - June 2026

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ALLIANCE FOR COLLECTIVE EMPOWERMENT

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WHY ACE EXISTS

For 400 years the Black church has been the place our people went when the world outside offered nothing. Not just for worship. For organizing. For survival. For the belief that something better was not only possible but promised.

ACE is building the thing the church has been preparing people for. Not a metaphor. A city. Real land, real schools, real hospitals, real courts, a real economy governed by the people who live inside it. Two of the most spiritually resilient peoples in human history, building together on sovereign ground.

We are not asking you to leave your ministry. We are asking you to extend it toward the most concrete expression of the promised land this generation has ever had the opportunity to build.

THE PROMISED LAND IS NOT A METAPHOR

Two of the most spiritually resilient peoples in human history Black Americans and Native Americans are building a real community on sovereign land, governed by their own laws, sustained by their own economy, grounded in their own culture and faith.

The Alliance for Collective Empowerment (ACE) is a 25-year initiative to establish self-governing, self-sustaining cities for Black and Native American communities on tribal land across the United States. Real land. Real governance. Real schools where our children learn who they are before the world tells them who to be. Real hospitals where no Black mother fears the delivery room. Real courts that deliver justice instead of processing our people into cages.

This is not a program you can apply for. It is not a government initiative you can petition. It is a civilization our communities are building together, for ourselves, on our own terms, with our own resources.

Your congregation is ready for this. They have been hearing about the promised land their whole lives. ACE is asking you to show them that it is not a distant spiritual destination, it is a city being built, and there is a place in it for every family willing to help build it.

The historically Black church has been the spine of Black community life in America for 400 years. Through slavery, through Reconstruction, through Jim Crow, through the Civil Rights Movement. Every time our people needed to organize around something larger than themselves, they gathered in a church. ACE is the next thing worth gathering around. And we are asking for your leadership.

THE ASK

We are asking you to become an ACE Community Ministry Partner. Here is what that means:

- Host one ACE town hall for your congregation let your members hear the vision directly from ACE leadership and ask their questions.

- Share ACE's Community Investment Bond program with your congregation investment in ACE starts at \$500, making co-ownership of this vision accessible to every working family in your community.
- Serve as a trusted community validator, your endorsement carries the weight of your relationship with your congregation. If you believe this is real and worth building, sayso.
- Join the ACE Community Advisory Council, a formal advisory body giving ministry leaders a voice in ACE's direction and a platform that extends beyond your congregation to the national ACE community.

We are not asking you to leave your ministry. We are asking you to extend it.

Every generation has its moment. This is ours. Will you open the door?

The full ACE Act is enclosed. Thank you for your time.